CHAPTER 9

USING WORDSTAR WITH OTHER FILE FORMATS

In this chapter you'll learn about

- Creating Fax Files
- Converting Graphics Files to .PIX Format

The Fax feature allows you to create fax files from WordStar documents and to send the files without printing them first or using a fax machine. First you create a .PCX graphics file for each page you want to fax. Then, you can use a fax board and fax software to transmit the files. If your fax board doesn't support .PCX files, you need to convert the files. Most fax software provides a conversion utility.

WordStar can insert graphics into your document. If the graphics file is not in .PIX format, WordStar converts the file for you. You can choose certain settings, such as the height and width of the graphic, when you convert the file.

CREATING FAX FILES

Although you can use any printer description file (PDF) to format a document for fax transmission, you get the best appearing fonts when you format the document for a laser printer. If you don't have a laser printer, you can use the FAX.PDF file that comes with WordStar.

To complete the following steps, you need a document to fax. Assign a laser printer (PDF) file or FAX.PDF to the document. For more information on using PDFs, see the "Printing" chapter.

CREATING FAX FILES AT THE OPENING SCREEN

In the following steps, you'll create a fax file from the Opening screen. (You can also create fax files from the Editing screen and from inside Preview.)

1. At the Opening screen, choose File→Fax (F,F).

2. In the Fax dialog box, type the name of the WordStar document to fax.

3. Press Alt+N (or the Tab key) to move the cursor to the Name of Fax File. Type five characters that describe your file, for example, **chart**.

   WordStar adds three numbers to indicate the page sequence. WordStar also adds the extension .PCX to the filename. For example, if you type **chart** for the filename and choose to create fax files for pages 3, 5, and 6, the filenames will be CHART001.PCX, CHART002.PCX, and CHART003.PCX. WordStar creates a file for each page.

4. Press the Tab key to move to the Fax Page Numbers option and select the pages to fax. To fax all pages, press Alt+A. To print selected pages, press Alt+S, and type the page numbers. You can select multiple ranges and discontinuous pages.

   Note: The page numbers refer to the physical position of the page in the document. Any page numbering commands you may have entered will be ignored.

5. Move the cursor to the Resolution options and select the resolution for your fax.

The resolution setting should match the setting in your fax board software. Resolution can be set to Low, High, or Special 300 dots per inch (dpi). Low resolution is 200 x 100 dpi. High resolution, the default, is 200 x 200 dpi. The 300 dpi option is provided for fax drivers that use this resolution. (The 9-Pin Dot Matrix and 24-Pin Dot Matrix options are not used for creating fax files.)

6 Choose the View button to view the file and verify the pages to fax.

Page one of your document appears. All the options on the Preview menus are available. You can preview any part of the file.

7 To determine the resolution of the fax printout, check the Preview display at 4x zoom (View menu).

8 Press Esc to return to the Fax dialog box.

The Fax dialog box should look like this:

```
                                   Fax
      File to Fax: C:\WS\CHART.DOC                                OK
Fax File Location: C:\WS\FAX                                      Cancel
 Name of Fax File: CHART 001.PCX          Resolution:             View
                                            o Low
 Fax Page Numbers:                          ◆ High
    ◆ All                                   o Special 300 dpi
    o Selected Pages:                       o 9-pin Dot Matrix
                                            o 24-pin Dot Matrix
```

9 Press F10 or choose OK to create fax files.

As the fax file is being created for each page, a view of the entire page displays in Preview. The name of the file being created appears at the top of the Preview screen. When all the required fax files have been created, WordStar returns you to the Opening screen.

10 Exit WordStar.

VIEWING FAX FILES OUTSIDE WORDSTAR

You can view fax files without starting WordStar. The first time you create a fax file, WordStar makes a FAX directory off the directory containing the FONTID.CTL file (usually the WS directory). All .PCX files are placed in this FAX directory. If you want to view files before you fax them, you can use the program SHOWPCX.

Follow the steps below to view a fax file at the DOS prompt.

1. Be sure you're logged on to the directory containing your WordStar files (usually WS).

2. Type **showpcx fax*filename*** (you don't need to type the .PCX extension), and press Enter to view your fax file.

   If you want to review the document, use the direction keys to move around the page. Use the plus and minus keys on the numeric keypad to change magnification.

3. Press Esc to return to the DOS prompt.

You can now send your fax files using your fax software.

The .PCX files created by WordStar are large files, averaging 100K each. To create additional disk space, you can delete fax files that you no longer need. When you create fax files, screen fonts (.CRT files) are also created. To delete .CRT files, you can run the DELCRT program. For more information on DELCRT, see the *Reference* manual.

CONVERTING GRAPHICS FILES TO .PIX FORMAT

WordStar can add graphics files to your documents. If your file is not in .PIX format, WordStar offers several options for converting the file.

For the following steps you'll need a graphics file that's in a format other than .PIX. You can use the sample graphics file WSILOGO.PCX.

If you haven't already installed Inset or Graphics Conversion, install them using the Add or Remove a Feature option on the WINSTALL menu. Follow the setup instructions in the "Inset" section of *Companion Programs*.

1. Start WordStar and open the file PLAYBILL.DOC or MAILING.DOC.

2. Move the cursor to where you want the graphic to appear.

3. Choose Insert→Graphic (Alt+I,G) to insert a graphic.

   The Insert Graphic dialog box appears.

4. Type **\ws\inset\wsilogo.pcx**. Press F10 or choose OK.

   The Convert Graphic dialog box appears. The name of the graphics file appears in the Original Filename box. The converted filename is the same as the original filename except for the .PIX extension.

```
                          Convert Graphic
The graphic you have chosen is not in WordStar format.          OK
WordStar will convert the graphic to .PIX format.
                                                              Cancel
 Original Filename: C:\WS\INSET\WSILOGO.PCX

Converted Filename: C:\WS\INSET\WSILOGO.PIX

Conversion Options:                                            Option
 ◆ Use Settings in File
 o Use Settings on Options Screen
```

5. Press the Tab key to accept the current name, or type a new name for the converted file and press the Tab key.

Before you convert the file you should review the conversion settings and change them as needed. Follow these steps to view/change the conversion options:

1. In the Convert Graphic dialog box, press the Down Arrow or ^X to select Use Settings on Options Screen.

2. Press O to choose Option.

The Convert Graphic Options dialog box displays.

```
                    Convert Graphic Options

  Height:  ...00"                          Colors:        OK
   Width:  ...00"                           o  2
  Aspect:  0          width/height          o  4          Cancel
Rotation:  0          degrees               ◆  16

[·] Reverse B/W
[·] Smoothness                             Process Type:
[·] Ignore Background                       ◆  Snap
                                            o  Halftone
Resolution:                                 o  Dither
      Horizontal:  0      dpi               o  Diffuse
        Vertical:  0      dpi
                                           Color Processing:
Screen Frequency:  0      lpi               ◆  Allow Color
        Contrast:  0                        o  Force Gray
      Brightness:  0                        o  Force B/W
```

Notice the Height, Width, and Aspect boxes in the Convert Graphic Options dialog box. These options are related. Specifying any two of the three values determines the third. Aspect (ratio) is defined as the width of a graphic divided by its height. Aspect ratios are indicated as decimal values.

3 Type values in the Height and Width boxes and the Aspect ratio will automatically be calculated. You won't see the calculation on the screen. Or, you can accept all values by pressing the Tab key.

For most conversions, you can use the default settings for the remaining options in the Convert Graphic Options dialog box.

4 Press F10 or choose OK to save your selections and return to the Convert Graphic dialog box.

5 In the Convert Graphic dialog box, press F10 or choose OK to convert the graphic and insert it into the document.

The graphic is converted to a .PIX file and inserted into your document. The settings you selected in the Convert Graphic Options dialog box are saved in the TOPIX.SET file. The next time you use this dialog box, the settings will reflect your changes.

You can use Preview to see how the graphic will look on the printed page.

6 Close and abandon the file.